LETICIA PIERAERTS

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Belgian and Spanish.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Theoretical and Empirical Industrial Organization, Environmental and Energy Economics, Electricity markets

POSITION

Université libre de Bruxelles, Belgium *Oct 2021 – now*
PhD Candidate in Economics in the ECARES research center
Supervisor: Estelle Cantillon

Financed by a grant from the Energy Transition Fund (Project Demandflex)

EDUCATION

Toulouse School of Economics, France *Jan 2026 – April 2026*
Visiting PhD Candidate in Environmental research group
Host: Stefan Ambec

Université libre de Bruxelles, Belgium *Sept 2021 – Sept 2023*
MRes Research in Economics
Magna cum Laude

Université libre de Bruxelles, Belgium *Sept 2019 – Aug 2021*
MSc Economics
Exchange semester at the Technical University of Munich (Germany)
Quantitative Techniques for Economics and Management (QTEM) network
Magna cum Laude

Université libre de Bruxelles, Belgium *Sept 2015 – Aug 2018*
BSc Economics
Magna cum Laude

WORKING PAPERS

Who benefits from the energy transition? Market power and flexibility in retail electricity markets
with Elise Viadere **[Job Market Paper]**

Abstract: The energy transition widens intraday spot price spreads—the difference between the most and least expensive hours of the day—raising the value of consumers' flexibility. We study a monopolist retailer offering contracts to consumers with heterogeneous, privately known intraday flexibility. In equilibrium, the retailer screens consumers through the contracts' price spread, and extracts surplus through the price level. Only the most flexible face the full spot price spread and consume efficiently; less flexible consumers face compressed price spreads. This distortion increases with the share of flexible consumers. The retailer captures most flexibility gains; low-flexibility consumers retain none.

ONGOING PROJECTS

Vertical arrangements and market power with real-time pricing: Evidence from the Spanish electricity market

Electricity market architecture, contracts and real-time price exposure of large industrial consumers *with Estelle Cantillon*

PUBLICATIONS

Cantillon, E., & Pieraerts, L. (2023). La transition énergétique en Belgique : États des lieux. In E. Cantillon, S. Brunet, J. Eyckmans, A. Gautier, M. Muûls, & F. Venmans (Eds.), Réussir la transition vers une économie zéro carbone. Editions de l'Université Ouverte.

POLICY WORK

Study on cost pass-through in energy retail markets 2018 – 24 (Belgium, France, Germany, Spain), for the European Commission – DG ENER (with Estelle Cantillon, Stefan Lamp, Mar Reguant, Isabelle Méjean, Mattia Nardotto and Elise Viadere)

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

2026: TSE Environmental Workshop (Toulouse), Energy Workshop (Madrid), EDF R&D Seminar (Paris), ENTER Conference (Madrid), EDF x TSE Workshop (Paris)

2025: Young Energy Economists and Engineers Seminar 2025 (Paris), FAEE PhD conference (Grenoble), CREG internal seminar (Brussels), ECARES PhD Day (Brussels), AEE annual conference [poster] (Paris)

2024: ECARES internal seminar, ECARES PhD seminar (Brussels)

2023: SRBE Study Day on Flexible Loads (Brussels), ETF Project Conference (Ghent), ECARES PhD seminar (Brussels)

2022: Energy Workshop (Toulouse)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

TA Advanced Industrial Organization, Faculty of Economics and Management (ULB) (2023)
For Mattia Nardotto (PhD course)

TA Energy Policy and Management, Ecole Polytechnique de Bruxelles (ULB) (2023, 2024, 2025)
For Benjamin Genêt (Master's course)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Estelle Cantillon (ULB) *June 2021 – Oct 2021*
Data cleaning and processing on the EU Emissions Trading Scheme

National Organization for Hydrogen and Fuel Cell Battery (NOW GmbH), Berlin (Germany) *Sept 2018 – Aug 2019*
Internship in Communication and Knowledge Management

TECHNICAL AND LANGUAGE SKILLS

Programming/statistical software: Python, R, STATA, LaTeX

Collaboration software: Git, Github, Overleaf

Languages: French (native), Spanish (native), English (C2), German (B2+)